TOOL 2 • CAPACITY & FOCUS

The Priority Kill Switch Form

> *The One-In, One-Out Rule: You cannot add mass to a full system without removing mass. When the team is at capacity, an existing Priority 1 must be explicitly paused, delayed, or stopped before a new Priority 1 initiative enters the system. If the team has real capacity, the initiative goes on the active list. No hidden carryover. No unspoken expectation that the team will do both.*

PART 1: THE CAPACITY CHECK (DO WE HAVE REAL CAPACITY?)

TEAM / FUNCTION _____ **NUMBER OF ACTIVE PRIORITIES TODAY** _____ **DATE** _____

- ☐ YES: the team has real capacity. Add the initiative to the active priorities list. Parts 2 to 4 are not required.
- ☐ NO: the team is at capacity. A trade-off is required. Complete Parts 2 to 4 before the new work starts.

PART 2: THE NEW PRIORITY (WHAT ENTERS THE SYSTEM)

NEW PRIORITY 1 INITIATIVE TITLE _____ **TARGET COMPLETION DATE** _____

REQUESTING LEADER / EXECUTIVE SPONSOR _____ **IMPACTED DEPARTMENT(S)** _____

WHY THIS WORK MATTERS NOW (STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE)

PART 3: THE TRADE-OFF (WHAT EXITS OR PAUSES)

CURRENT PRIORITY 1 INITIATIVE TO BE PAUSED, DELAYED, OR KILLED _____

ACTION

☐ Paused ☐ Delayed ☐ Killed

CURRENT OWNER OF THAT WORK _____ **NEW PROJECTED CHECKPOINT / RESTART DATE** _____

ACCEPTED RISK (WHAT RISK ARE WE EXPLICITLY ACCEPTING BY PAUSING THIS WORK?)

PART 4: EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY & SIGN-OFF

"By signing below, I acknowledge that the paused work will not remain an unspoken expectation for the team. I accept direct executive accountability for the risk created by this trade-off."

Requesting Leader Signature
Name & Date

Executive Approver / Operations Sponsor
Name & Date

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